

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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A BED TOO SHORT and A BLANKET TOO NARROW

Isaiah 28:20 The bed is too short to stretch out on and the blanket to narrow to wrap around you NIV.



**EXPERIENCING THOSE CIRCUMSTANCES
IN LIFE THAT FALLS SHORT OF THE EXPECTED SPIRITUAL
COVERING AND PROVISION.**

Something that is **DISCOMFORTING, TROUBLESOME** and **DISTURBING** TO A RESTFUL PEACEFUL LIFE **because** there has been a failure to walk in God's way and chose to pace our **CONFIDENCE** and **TRUST** in other things that cannot deliver.

- ✳ Like a bed too short and a blanket too narrow will not give a good restful sleep.
- ✳ We will toss and turn all night and wake tired and fatigued.

RESOURCES OF CONFIDENCE

- ✳ PUTTING OUR TRUST IN SUCH THINGS WILL ONLY RESULT IN ALL SOURCES FAILING TO **DELIVER CONFIDENCE**.
- ✳ **OUR CONFIDENCE GONE. – CONFIDENCE EVAPORATED** - how tragic and discouraging.

*Isaiah 28:20 They will find that the bed is too short for a man to stretch himself on and the covering to narrow for him to wrap himself in **all of his sources of confidence will fail him** AMP*

Israel's catastrophe

- ✳ Israel found themselves in this situation of discomfort and disappointment of failed expectations because they placed their trust in things apart for God and he declares that nothing that they try will suffice - **all of his sources of confidence will fail him. Nothing that they put their trust in will deliver**

Isaiah 28:20 The bed is too short to stretch out on and the blanket to narrow to wrap around you NIV.

*Isaiah 28:20 they will find that the bed is too short for a man to stretch himself on and the covering to narrow for him to wrap himself in, **all of his sources of confidence will fail him** AMP*

STRETCH – RESTRICTED - CRAMED IN – INSUFFICIENT SPACE

*Isaiah 28:20 For the bed is not long enough for a man to be **stretched** out on: and the cover is not wide enough for him to be covered with. BBE*

*Isaiah 28:20 The bed is too short to **stretch** out on. The blanket is too narrow to serve as a cover. GOD'S WORD*

*Isaiah 28:20 For, [as the saying goes,] “The bed is too short for a person to **stretch**, and the blanket too narrow [to protect him from cold] even if he **crams himself in.**” CJB*

*The word **stretch** is used also in the same verse in the following translations - KJV, NET, Webster, Darby, NASU*

Question:

Q. Have we every felt restricted and cramped in the events and circumstances that we are experiencing and cannot seem to be able to fit – to be able to stretch out and have room to be comfortable?

Q. Could it have been that IT WAS BECAUSE we PLACED our trust in THINGS AND PATHWAYS THAT ARE NOT FROM GOD?

Q. Have we ever experienced events and circumstance in our journey of following Jesus where we have tried certain solutions that we thought would give us rest and a measure of a comfort, covering BUT those things failed us miserably

Q. Has there ever been a time in your journey where you have found yourself in place of discomfort and hardship AS A RESULT OF you having placed your trust in things other than God himself? Things like horses and chariots, man's wisdom and things that cannot sustain us – like spider's webs, and we have suffered because of it? (Spiders webs) Job 8:13-15 - 13 The same happens to all who FORGET God. The hopes of the godless evaporate. - 14 Their confidence hangs by a thread. They are leaning on a spider's web. - 15 They cling to their home for security, but it won't last. They try to hold it tight, but it will not endure. NLT

Unfortunately, it seems that some lessons in life we find ourselves repeating again and again. The lesson of FAILING to trust in God and his ways and we seek to place our confidence in things that cannot cover, provide or sustain us.

What is the symbolic meaning of the blanket?

- By definition, a blanket is much more than a fabric you sleep under. It is a symbol of warmth and friendship. The action a wrapping someone in a blanket is a real statement of kindness and a demonstration of honor. In some native traditions a blanket is used to create and seal relationships.

What is the moral lesson of the blanket?

- Our behaviors / actions/ speech MODEL others – or family, children, students and believers.

DELUSIVE EXPECTATIONS

Isaiah 28:20 for the bed is shorter than that a man can stretch himself on it: and the covering narrower than can wrap himself in it

The proverb contains relevant truth for people today of every age

- THE OFFERS OF SATISFACTION THAT THE WORLD'S MAKES TO MAN'S NATURE.

1. FALSE CONFIDENCES

2. SELF EXCUSES

3. EMPTY HOPES

- MEN SEEK BEDS ON WHICH THEIR SOUL'S MAY REST AND BE COMFORTED – BUT TO NO AVAIL.

- ★ The bed of merriment, gaiety, fun
- ★ The bed of self-indulgence – pleasure seeking
- ★ The bed of pride – conceit, self-importance, arrogance
- ★ The bed of ambition - eager desire for social standing, fame, or power

1. ANYONE WHOSE PRIDE WILL NOT ALLOW THEM TO REPENT OF KNOWN SINS – is in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

2. THIS IS ALSO TRUE OF THE UNREPENTANT SINNER – is in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

3. ANYONE WHO WANTS AN IMMORAL LIFESTYLE WHILE TRYING TO HANG ON TO A SEMBLANCE OF CHRISTIANITY - is in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

4. ANYONE WHO seeks to SERVE GOD WITH PRIDE AND LACK OF SUBMISSION - is "in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

5. ANYONE WHO holds to a DIFFERENT standard to how God states Salvation is received – is also in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

6. FOR ANYONE WHO has qualifications for being a true disciple of Christ which are different to those which Jesus gave – is a person in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow.

FINALLY,

7. ANYONE WHO IS UNPREPARED TO FACE GOD RIGHT NOW, is in a bed too short, with a blanket too narrow. It will not cover or comfort.

★ God's prophet described Israel's spiritual condition which was deplorable, and God was not pleased with it.

★ May we learn to regularly check ourselves that we are placing our trust in God and walking in the paths that contain the core values that God gave us to successfully and fruitfully live by

AMEN – Ps Barry